INDIVIDUAL LEARNING REPORT

Version: 1.0

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Table of contents

***Part 1*: Learning Objectives** **2**

Professional Expertise *2*

Learning Ability *2*

Communication Skills *2*

***Part 2*: Lessons learned part 1** **3**

***Part 3*: Midterm self-reflection** **4**

***Part 4*: Learning Objectives for the second half of the project** **5**

Part 1: Learning Objectives

Professional Expertise

I want to gain more knowledge how users can be authenticated. During the project I will be responsible for the authentication of our application. I have no previous knowledge about this IT subject, so it will be very interesting and challenging for me. This learning objective can be measured by looking at the end result of the project, where the user will be able to login and my investigation.

Learning Ability

Unfortunately due to covid-19 we need to make this project from our homes. This can be quite challenging for me, because there are a lot of distractions at home. I want to learn what my weak and strong points are. So that I can work on my weak points and thrive on my strong points. I am going to accomplish this by reflecting every 4 weeks, on my work drive and how long I can stay focused. This learning objective can be measured by the retrospectives after every sprint. This will start from 11 March.

Communication Skills

I want to accomplish that my team has a structured and clear way of communication. Especially since we are all working for home I think it is very important. I am going to accomplish this by taking up the role of the secretary in my team. This means that I am responsible for making the planning, including the deadlines for the project as own set deadlines. Also I will be sending active reminders to team members when necessary. This learning objective can be measured by asking feedback from my team members at the end of the project.

Part 2: Lessons learned part 1

Sprint number: 1
Date: 06-04-2021

Activities
During the sprint I worked on securing our API by making use of bearer authentication. This can be used later to implement the user authentication. To get this working I made use of Azure Active Directory to secure our API. Once this is done I secured our API end points, the last point that needs to get done is writing the necessary code into the client app. This will be done by the front-end team and not me. To help them I made a document where all the data is collected that is needed and the resources to make it work. That's how I worked on my professional expertise.

I worked on my learning ability by reflecting on myself during the retrospective. One point that stood out to me was that I find it hard to ask for help. For example, I needed to get acquainted with the API instead of asking Mathijs or Timber I tried to do it on my own. Unfortunately this took too much time and I still had to ask for their help. In the future I want to push myself to quicker ask for help if this is necessary. This way I can get more things done in a shorter time frame and that is what I want.

Unfortunately we are all working from home and this makes communication difficult sometimes. I made sure to send reminders when a deadline was approaching. I also made an agenda for when we need to have finished certain individual assessment, so that we can add those to our group assessment. I found it nice that in one look, my team members have an overview for what needs to get done.

Learned lessons
I asked my team members for feedback, they liked that I keep an eye on the deadlines to make sure everyone finishes it on time. The role that I have in this team is the secretary, I like that my team members think that I am fulfilling my role well. Besides that I have received the feedback that I bring a positive atmosphere to the team and have a proactive work attitude. Unfortunately my proactive attitude can be overwhelming for other team members. That's why in the next sprint I want to give everyone their space to talk. The last point that was mentioned is that I need to try ask for help in time and involve myself in the work of others. This way I avoid realizing to late that I am doing double or wrong work. I learned from this sprint that my teams think that I am an involved and active member. However there are still some points that I need to work on as mentioned above.

Part 3: Midterm self-reflection

During a feedback meeting with my team members, I have received feedback on the following competences below:

Professional expertise: I always finish my work on time, one thing that helps me with this is working with scrum. This is the first time that I am working with this structure in a professional setting. By clearly describing what I want to do in a sprint and giving an time estimating, so that my team and I have an indication on the work that needs to be doing. I have received the feedback that my user stories are clearly written, the improvement part here is that in the next sprint I need to add a definition of done.

Research skills: One of my responsibilities during this project is setting up the authentication for our application, because I haven't got any knowledge about this subject I needed to investigate a lot. On the internet I looked for multiple tutorials and documentation, I also attended meetings with developers. I received the feedback from these developers that they found that I had an creative mindset and a general understanding of the subject. I can find relevant information and distills the essence from this information.

Communication skills: My team members found that I always reminded them about the deadlines and important upcoming events. Next to that I made a general agenda where all the deliverables are described and what needs to be done for this.

Collaboration skills: Our team is split in half, one part of the team works on the front-end and the other half on the back-end. I work on the back-end with Timber and Mathijs, one particular thing that they mentioned both is that if I need help to ask it faster. During last sprint it was the case, that I waited too long to ask for help. This resulted in that I took me twice the time to finish a task. In this next sprint I want to give myself a maximum of 2 hours to figure something out for myself. If is still haven't found the answer I will ask for help to one of my team members.

The positive feedback that I received was that I am great motivator during the meetings to keep ideas and productivity high. I involve others in conversations, ask for their input and am not afraid to make decisions. Besides that they feel that I am a person whom can always be contacted to discuss something (after project hours). I am really glad to hear that my team members feel that I have a proactive work attitude.

Learning ability: The feedback that I have received from my team members, is that I don't need to be afraid to speak my mind and give feedback to other people. I can find myself in this, because we all work online I am cautious of my words so that I unintentionally offend a member of my team. However after hearing this feedback I think that I have been too cautious, in the next sprint I will speak up more if this is necessary.

Part 4: Learning Objectives for the second half of the project

I don’t want to alter my current learning objectives, I feel like I am doing a good job at working on my learning objectives however I am not fully satisfied with the result. I still want to develop myself further on these learning objectives.